Laura Weiwu

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Positions

Assistant Professor, UC Berkeley Haas School of Business 2025-
Postdoctoral Fellow, Stanford Department of Economics 2024-2025

Education

PhD in Economics, Massachusetts Institute of Technology 2018-2024
Dissertation: "Essays on Inequality in Cities"
Committee: David Autor, Dave Donaldson, David Atkin

BA in Economics, *with Honors and Distinction*, Stanford University 2014-2018
BS in Applied Mathematics, *with Distinction*, Stanford University 2014-2018

Other Positions

Faculty Affiliate, Berkeley Opportunity Lab 2026-
Visiting Scholar, Harvard Department of Economics Sep-Oct 2026
Census Special Sworn Status Researcher 2024-

Research Interests

Labor, Urban/Spatial, Economic History

Working Papers

1. Unequal Access: Racial Segregation and the Distributional Impacts of Interstate Highways in Cities
Revision Requested, American Economic Review
— Allan Nevins Prize for best dissertation in American history, Economic History Association
— Best Student Paper Prize, Urban Economics Association

2. Opportunity in Motion: Infrastructure, Job Access, and Intergenerational Mobility
— Russell Sage Foundation Grant, Upjohn Institute Early Career Award

3. Changing Intergenerational Mobility and Family Structure: Evidence from New Linkages for the Mid-20th Century (with Martha Stinson)

4. Measuring Winners and Losers from Increasing Housing Supply (with Vincent Rollet)

Works in Progress

5. New Origins, New Impacts? Immigration and Local Labor Markets
(with Ran Abramitzky, Leah Boustan, and Yulia Valdivia Rivera)

6. The Intergenerational Effects of Local Shocks: Income, Migration, and Human Capital
(with Martha Stinson and Sean Wang)

7. Is Public Housing Good or Bad for Families? (with Beau Bressler and Dani Sandler)

Publications

Essays on Inequality in Cities: Evidence from the Interstate Highway System
Dissertation summary for the Allan Nevins Prize for best dissertation in American economic history.
Journal of Economic History, 2025, 85(2), 549-554

Other Papers

Intergenerational Linkages between Historical IRS 1040 Data and the Numident: 1964-1979 Cohorts (with Martha Stinson)
Census Bureau Center for Economic Studies (CES) Technical Note

Fellowships and Awards

Provostial Fellowship (university-wide), Stanford	2024-2025
Best Graduate TA of the Year (Top 3), MIT Economics	2024
Institute for Humane Studies Fellowship	2023
C. Lowell Harriss Dissertation Fellowship, Lincoln Institute of Land Policy	2023
Graduate Women of Excellence, MIT	2023
Graduate Student Council Teaching Award in the School of Humanities, Arts, and Social Sciences (SHASS), *one professor or TA from each school*, MIT	2021
National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship	2018-2023
Department of Economics Graduate Fellowship, MIT	2018-2020
David M. Kennedy Thesis Prize, *best thesis in the social sciences*, Stanford	2018
Firestone Medal, *best thesis in Economics*, Stanford	2018
Phi Beta Kappa, *elected as Junior*, Stanford	2017
R. Richard Hodge Undergraduate Scholarship, Stanford	2015-2017

Grants

Russell Sage Foundation Sheldon Danziger Pipeline Grant ($50K)	2026-2028
Upjohn Institute Early Career Research Award	2026
George and Obie Shultz Fund Grant (x4), MIT Economics	2020, 2023

Refereeing

American Economic Journal: Applied Economics, American Economic Journal: Economic Policy, American Economic Review, American Economic Review: Insights, Econometrica, Journal of Development Economics, Journal of the European Economic Association, Journal of Political Economy, Journal of Political Economy: Microeconomics, Journal of Public Economics, Journal of Urban Economics, Quarterly Journal of Economics, Review of Economics and Statistics

Conferences & Seminars

2027	ASSA/AEA, Claremont McKenna, UC Santa Cruz (applied micro & trade)
2026	UC Irvine (labor/public), West Coast Spatial Workshop at Stanford, O-Lab Conference on Infrastructure/Housing, UC Berkeley (joint labor & history), Online Spatial and Urban Seminar, O-Lab Conference on Economic Opportunity, All-California Labor Economics Conference, Urban Economics Association (North America), Universitat Pompeu Fabra (applied micro), Columbia-NYU-Yale Housing Day, Yale Government Effectiveness Seminar & Yale Economic History, UW Madison (real estate), Princeton (labor/public)
2025	AREUEA-ASSA (discussant), Bocconi (applied micro), LSE (trade/urban), UCLA (trade), Harvard Opportunity Insights seminar, Stanford (labor & history), Chicago-Princeton Spatial Economics Conference, UC Berkeley Haas RE seminar, NYU (trade), Urban Economics Association (North America), NBER Transportation

Networks and the Spatial Distribution of Economic Activity, University of Toronto (urban)

2024 Stanford, Stanford GSB, Dartmouth, UC Berkeley Haas, UChicago Booth, UChicago Harris, UPenn Wharton, Boston University, Department of Transportation, Northwestern Kellogg (Strategy RookieFest), Society of Labor Economists, UChicago & Federal Reserve Bank of Cleveland Barriers to Economic Opportunity Workshop, Urban Economics Association (Europe), Barcelona Institute for Economics (Urban Workshop), Economic History Association, Northwestern (history), LSE Barriers to Economic Opportunity Workshop, UC Davis (history), UBC Sauder, UC San Diego (trade/spatial), Opportunity Insights Conference, UW Madison (public)

2023 RUSH (Regional/Urban/Spatial/Housing) Brownbag, NBER Economics of Transportation, Urban Economics Association Summer School, NBER Summer Institute: Urban Economics, U.S. Census Bureau, MIT (applied micro), Harvard/Boston University Economic History Workshop, Urban Economics Association (North America),

2022 Urban Economics Association (Europe), Jerusalem Advanced School in Economic Theory for International Economics, Rising Scholars Chicago Booth, U.S. Census Bureau

Teaching

PHDBA 289A: Special Topics in Urban Economics, UC Berkeley	Fall 2026-
MBA 280: Real Estate Investment & Market Analysis, UC Berkeley	Spring 2027-
UGBA 180: Intro to Real Estate and Urban Economics, UC Berkeley	Spring 2026-
14.662: PhD Labor Economics, TA with David Autor and Nina Roussille, MIT (6.6/7)	Spring 2024

Relevant Past Positions

Economist (part-time), U.S. Census Bureau	2020-2024
Research Assistant to David Autor, MIT	2019
Research Intern at the Federal Reserve Bank of New York	2017
Research Assistant to Rebecca Diamond & Petra Persson, Stanford	2016-2017
Research Intern at the White House's Council of Economic Advisers	2016
Research Assistant to Matthew Gentzkow, Stanford	2015-2016

Conference Organizing

Conference on Urban and Regional Economics (CURE) at Columbia, Scientific Committee	2026
All-California Labor Economics Conference, Co-Organizer	2025-2026

Department Service

Berkeley Haas Real Estate and Urban Economics Seminar, Co-Organizer	2025-
RUSH (Regional/Urban/Spatial/Housing) Graduate Brownbag	2022-2023
MIT Mental Health & Peer Support, Co-Founder and Organizer	2019-2024

Invited Discussions

ASSA 2027	Political Alignment and Neighborhood Choice Among Homebuyers by Cai et al.
NBER SI 2026	Family Ties, Residential Location Choice, and Labor Supply by Avivi, Lacouture, Lobel, and van Dijk
OSUS 2026	Choices or Constraints? Disentangling Preferences and Restrictions in Housing Markets by Almagro and Sood
ASSA 2025	Families, Neighbourhoods and Children's Educational Outcomes by Dahlberg, Santavirta, Stenberg, Yakymmovych

Last Updated: September 2026